Ayano Yokoyama

UX & Content Designer | User Flows, Interface Copy and Conversation Design | Localization

PROFILE

UX and content designer with a background in localization. I design user flows, interface copy and conversations, drawing on 10+ years of working with digital products across languages and markets. Most recently at hermaid, a digital health startup, I planned and ran user research, designed the webinar and events feature, and designed chatbot flows and escalation logic for sensitive health conversations. Earlier, at Freeletics, I owned the Japanese version of the app and website and passed what I heard from users to UX, product and localization teams. Native Japanese and English.

CORE SKILLS

UX and product design: user flows, journey mapping, wireframes, prototypes, UI design in Figma (auto layout, components, team libraries), responsive layouts

Content design and UX writing: interface copy and microcopy, content hierarchy, voice and tone guidelines, style guides and glossaries, Help Center content, bilingual Japanese/English UX writing

Research: user surveys, in-person concept testing, competitive research, qualitative synthesis, turning findings into recommendations

Conversation design and AI: chatbot flows, escalation logic, AI-assisted prototyping and research

Localization: Japanese product localization, transcreation, terminology, linguistic QA, localization process and handoff

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UX Research & Product Content Design | hermaid, Berlin | Feb 2026 – Jul 2026

Early-stage digital health app for women in perimenopause and menopause, available in German and English. Small team with the founder, a product designer and a developer.

- Planned and ran the user research, including a bilingual survey with 53 respondents and competitive research, and turned the findings into recommendations.
- Designed the flow, screens and UI copy for a webinar and events feature, including topic and expert filters and access to past sessions.
- Showed a simple mockup of the community feature to users at an in-person event; their response moved the feature higher on the roadmap.
- Designed chatbot conversation flows and a six-tier escalation model defining when the assistant answers, guides the user or hands over to a person.
- Built quick prototypes, including mock chatbot versions, to help the team see options; shared research and concepts in sprint reviews.

Product & Content Design | Independent Practice, Berlin | Sep 2023 – Dec 2025

- Built portfolio case studies in product, content and conversation design (see Selected Projects).
- Designed Naia, a home-fitness app concept: research synthesis, user journey, workout-setup flow, voice and tone guidance, inclusive microcopy and a usability-testing plan.
- Built personal apps and my portfolio site with AI-assisted coding (Claude Code), including a Karuta learning app and a workout planner.
- Completed training in UX writing, accessibility and product localization.

Career break with UX design training | Berlin | Oct 2021 – Aug 2023 - Completed the CareerFoundry UX Design program and the Google UX Design Professional Certificate.

Country Manager Japan / Market Entry & Localization Lead | Nordic Oil, Munich | Mar 2021 – Oct 2021

- Responsible for the content of the products planned for launch in Japan, across e-commerce, product messaging, FAQ and customer education content, in a seven-language operation.
- Co-developed Japanese web and social content and coordinated visual content with in-house designers, together with the Head of Japan Operations.
- Proposed shared localization processes, a translation memory and a handoff checklist to reduce manual work and inconsistency; partially adopted.

- Researched the Japanese market and customers to refine positioning and product messaging; carried out keyword research and on-page SEO.

Customer Engagement & Product Collaboration | Freeletics, Munich | Sep 2018 – Mar 2021

- Answered user inquiries for a consumer fitness app and identified recurring questions, pain points and confusing moments.
- Passed what I heard from users, including culturally specific insights for Japanese users, to UX, product and localization teams.
- Created and maintained Help Center content for troubleshooting and self-service (Zendesk).
- Kept the Japanese support tone aligned with the global in-app voice.

Content Localization Specialist, Japanese | Freeletics, Munich | Apr 2016 – Sep 2018

- Owned the Japanese version of the Freeletics website and Bodyweight app, including tone, terminology and UI content quality.
- Built translation guidelines, a glossary and a tone framework to keep content consistent; worked with an external Japanese translator.
- Adapted onboarding and in-app copy for Japanese users with UX and content teams, and ran linguistic QA on app releases.

Content Localization & Market Research Coordinator | Vesseltracker, Hamburg & Tokyo | May 2014 – May 2015

- Localized the UX/UI content of a map-based maritime tracking and analytics platform for Japanese users.
- Ran Japanese market and competitor research and turned it into recommendations for positioning and market entry.

Digital Strategy / Creative Strategy Assistant | Advertising agencies, Amsterdam & Hamburg | 2011 – 2012

- Research, deck building and concept support within creative teams, including pitch materials.

SELECTED PROJECTS

hermaid: live events and webinars: flows, screens and bilingual UX writing for webinar discovery and past sessions (portfolio)

PlutoPay (CareerFoundry project): fintech concept from research and usability testing to Figma prototype; working prototype rebuilt with AI-assisted coding

Food on Wheels (group project): user interviews, research synthesis, personas and early flows

Nike By You (Bitesize UX workshop): UX writing exercise: voice and tone, before/after copy for a product customization flow

EDUCATION & TRAINING

- Google UX Design Professional Certificate
- CareerFoundry: UX Design; Web Development
- UX Writing Hub: UX Writing Academy
- UX Content Collective: Accessibility for UX Writers and Designers; Product Localization for UX
- Miami Ad School Europe: Diploma in Strategic Planning

LANGUAGES

Japanese (native), English (native), Spanish (professional working), Portuguese (limited working), German (basic)

TOOLS

Design and research: Figma, Adobe XD, Adobe Creative Suite, Miro, Maze, Dovetail, UserTesting

AI: Claude, Claude Code, ChatGPT, NotebookLM, Perplexity, Lovable, Google Stitch

Localization and content: Phrase (Memsource), Lokalise, Smartling, memoQ, Zendesk, WordPress

Collaboration: Jira, Trello, Asana, Microsoft Teams